

Table 1: Raw mass and length measurements of the string segment

| Mass $m$ (g) | Length $L$ (cm) |
|--------------|-----------------|
| 0.0286       | 100.00          |
| 0.0338       | 115.00          |
| 0.0299       | 100.00          |

Table 2: Raw standing-wave resonance measurements at different hanging masses

| Hanging mass $m$ (g) | Antinode count $n$ | Resonance frequency $f_n$ (Hz) | Antinode width $\lambda_n/2$ (cm) |
|----------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------|
| 50.26                | 2                  | 100.5                          | 62.5                              |
| 50.26                | 3                  | 150.5                          | 42.3                              |
| 50.26                | 4                  | 201.2                          | 32.0                              |
| 60.64                | 2                  | 111.6                          | 61.5                              |
| 60.64                | 3                  | 167.9                          | 42.7                              |
| 60.64                | 4                  | 223.5                          | 31.9                              |
| 70.06                | 2                  | 118.8                          | 63.5                              |
| 70.06                | 3                  | 178.7                          | 41.7                              |
| 70.06                | 4                  | 238.8                          | 33.0                              |
| 80.16                | 2                  | 127.0                          | 63.3                              |
| 80.16                | 3                  | 191.2                          | 44.2                              |
| 80.16                | 4                  | 255.2                          | 31.0                              |
| 90.10                | 2                  | 135.2                          | 63.5                              |
| 90.10                | 3                  | 204.2                          | 40.5                              |
| 90.10                | 4                  | 272.2                          | 33.1                              |

Table 3: Wave speed inferred from the resonance measurements, at different rope tensions

| Rope tension $T = mg$ (N) | Wave speed $v = f_n \lambda_n$ (m s <sup>-1</sup> ) |
|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 0.4925                    | $127.24 \pm 0.91$                                   |
| 0.5943                    | $141.1 \pm 2.0$                                     |
| 0.6866                    | $152.5 \pm 2.6$                                     |
| 0.7856                    | $162.7 \pm 3.3$                                     |
| 0.8830                    | $172.4 \pm 4.3$                                     |

Table 4: Regression of  $v^2$  against  $T$ , and the resulting estimate of the string’s linear density

| Quantity                                                    | Value                              |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| Slope $s$ (m <sup>2</sup> s <sup>-2</sup> N <sup>-1</sup> ) | $(3.54 \pm 0.23) \times 10^4$      |
| $\mu_{\text{obs}} \equiv 1/s$ (kg m <sup>-1</sup> )         | $(2.82 \pm 0.19) \times 10^{-5}$   |
| $\mu_{\text{ref}}$ (kg m <sup>-1</sup> )                    | $(2.930 \pm 0.038) \times 10^{-5}$ |
| Error                                                       | -3.63%                             |

Table 5: Raw resonance frequency measurements of the metal ring at different antinode counts

| Antinode count $n$ | Resonance frequency $f$ (Hz) |
|--------------------|------------------------------|
| 3                  | 20.5                         |
| 4                  | 44.2                         |
| 5                  | 73.6                         |
| 7                  | 153.2                        |
| 9                  | 266.4                        |
| 11                 | 398.9                        |

Table 6: Regression of  $\log f$  against  $\log n$  for the metal ring, compared with the theoretical exponent of 2

| Quantity  | Value             |
|-----------|-------------------|
| Slope $s$ | $2.333 \pm 0.061$ |
| Error     | 16.64%            |

Table 7: Comparing the observed resonance frequency with the  $f$ - $n^2$  fit’s prediction, at antinode counts not used in the fit

| Antinode count $n$ | Observed frequency $f_{\text{obs}}$ (Hz) | Predicted frequency $f_{\text{theo}}$ (Hz) | Error  |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|--------|
| 4                  | 44.2                                     | 43.1                                       | 2.55%  |
| 11                 | 398.9                                    | 401.5                                      | −0.64% |

Table 8: Basic measurements of the spring used in the longitudinal-wave experiment

| Quantity                  | Value |
|---------------------------|-------|
| Natural length $L_0$ (cm) | 7.50  |
| Spring mass $M$ (g)       | 11.46 |

Table 9: Raw scale readings used to measure the spring constant

| Hanging mass $m$ (g) | Upper-loop scale reading $L_{\text{up}}$ (cm) | Lower-loop scale reading $L_{\text{low}}$ (cm) |
|----------------------|-----------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| 10.14                | 62.30                                         | 54.10                                          |
| 20.04                | 62.05                                         | 46.50                                          |
| 30.14                | 61.90                                         | 38.05                                          |
| 40.06                | 61.90                                         | 29.85                                          |
| 50.30                | 61.85                                         | 21.50                                          |

Table 10: Extension of the spring under different restoring forces

| Restoring force $F = mg$ (N) | Extension $x = L_{\text{up}} - L_{\text{low}} - L_0$ (m) |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|
| 0.09937                      | 0.0070                                                   |
| 0.1964                       | 0.0805                                                   |
| 0.2954                       | 0.1635                                                   |
| 0.3926                       | 0.2455                                                   |
| 0.4929                       | 0.3285                                                   |

Table 11: Regression of  $F$  against  $x$ ; by Hooke's law the slope is the spring constant  $K$ 

| Quantity                        | Value               |
|---------------------------------|---------------------|
| Slope $K$ ( $\text{N m}^{-1}$ ) | $1.216 \pm 0.014$   |
| y-intercept (N)                 | $0.0946 \pm 0.0027$ |

Table 12: Raw resonance frequency measurements of the spring's longitudinal standing wave

| Antinode count $n$ | Resonance frequency $f$ (Hz) |
|--------------------|------------------------------|
| 7                  | 36.8                         |
| 8                  | 41.9                         |
| 9                  | 47.1                         |
| 10                 | 52.5                         |
| 11                 | 57.5                         |

Table 13: Regression of  $f$  against  $n$  for the spring, compared with the theoretical slope  $\sqrt{K/M}/2$ 

| Quantity                                                | Value             |
|---------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Slope $s$ (Hz)                                          | $5.200 \pm 0.033$ |
| Theoretical slope $s_{\text{theo}} = \sqrt{K/M}/2$ (Hz) | $5.151 \pm 0.029$ |
| Error                                                   | 0.94%             |

Table 14: Regression of  $\log f$  against  $\log n$  for the spring, compared with the theoretical exponent of 1

| Quantity                                                         | Value               |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Slope $s$                                                        | $0.9919 \pm 0.0060$ |
| Error                                                            | -0.81%              |
| y-intercept $b$                                                  | $0.7271 \pm 0.0057$ |
| Theoretical y-intercept $b_{\text{theo}} = \log s_{\text{theo}}$ | $0.7119 \pm 0.0024$ |
| Error                                                            | 2.14%               |